

Agentic PMS — End-to-End Testing Guide

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Product: Agentic PMS · **Environment:** <https://pms.agentic humans.in>
Written for: UAT testers, HR reviewers, and anyone signing off a release
As of: 22 September 2026 · covers everything through commit `6e4913b`, plus the Quarterly Connects menu move (pending deploy at the time of writing)

This guide walks the product the way a real appraisal year runs, in order. Work top to bottom and each section leaves the data the next one needs.

Every test case has an ID (`KRA-03`), the role that performs it, what to do, and what should happen. Record PASS / FAIL against the ID.

0. Before you start

0.1 The five things that will block testing if you skip them

These are **data and configuration on your side**, not product defects. Each one stops a whole section of this guide dead. Fix them first.

#	Blocker	What it blocks	Who fixes it
1	No user holds the <code>hr</code> role. One <code>admin</code> account exists (<code>hr.admin@mindgate.com</code>); 0 <code>hr</code> , 5 <code>hod</code> , 239 <code>manager</code> .	Everything in §2, §9 and §10. You cannot test "HR does X" with no HR user.	HR/IT
2	The KRA library has no Department values — 0 of 2,155 rows.	Department-based shelves (§3.2). Every employee falls back to the designation-only shelf.	HR
3	<code>Senior Software Engineer</code> shelf totals 105%.	Anyone on that shelf cannot submit (weights must total 100). Either fix the shelf or avoid that designation in testing.	HR
4	4 designations have no shelf at all — Vice President I (×11), Senior Vice President II (×3), Senior Vice President I (×1), Senior Administrator - Network and System (×1).	Those 16 people get an empty sheet. Expected, not a bug — but don't pick them as test subjects.	HR
5	61 active employees have no reporting manager.	Their KRAs can be submitted but never approved. Pick test employees who have a manager.	HR

0.2 Accounts you need

Create or nominate one real person per row. **Test with real logins, not by impersonating** — permissions are the thing under test.

Role	Needed for	Minimum
<code>employee</code>	§3–§7, §11	2 (one reporting to your test manager)
<code>manager</code>	§3.5, §5, §6, §8, §9	1 (must be the manager of the employees above)
<code>hod</code>	§8	1 (must be head of the test employee's department)
<code>hr</code>	§2, §5, §9, §10	1
<code>admin</code>	§12	1 (already exists)

To grant a role: Employees tab → the person → **Role** dropdown → Save. Set a password on the same panel if they have never signed in.

⚠ Changing someone's role reopens their submitted KRA sheet, growth plan and mid-year review, and notifies them and their manager. Nothing is lost, but it is a real event. Set your test users' roles up **before** they submit anything, or you will spend \$4 chasing a reopen you caused yourself.

0.3 The one concept to understand first

The cycle has 9 phases, and they run in a fixed order:

```
draft → kra_open → mid_year_review → self_appraisal → manager_eval  
→ hod_eval → calibration → publish → closed
```

HR moves the cycle one step at a time (Cycles tab). You can only advance to the **next** phase, and roll back to the **previous** one.

But KRAs are deliberately NOT locked to a phase. A KRA sheet can be edited, submitted and decided in **every phase** except **draft** and **closed**. What locks a KRA is **the sheet's own status**, not the cycle:

Sheet status	Who can edit
draft	the employee
returned	the employee (with a reason shown)
submitted	nobody — it is with the manager
approved	nobody, until HR reopens it

If you expect "KRAs should be locked now that we're in Mid-Year", **that expectation is wrong** — it was changed on request. See **KRA-07**.

1. Smoke test — is the environment alive?

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
SMK-01	any	Open <code>https://pms.agentichumans.in</code>	Login page renders
SMK-02	any	Sign in	Lands on My KRAs; your name and role show bottom-left
SMK-03	any	Open every nav item visible to you	No blank screens, no error banners
SMK-04	employee	Sign in as a plain employee	HR Admin items (Employees, KRA Library, Settings, Increment Simulation, Review Analysis, Department Heads, Career Pathing Matrix, Completion Report) are not visible
SMK-05	employee	Type <code>/admin/directory</code> directly in the URL bar	Blocked — not rendered. Hiding a link is not access control; this checks the guard
SMK-06	any	Read the My Performance group top to bottom	Order is My KRAs · My Growth · Quarterly Connects · Mid-Year Review · Annual Review · Final Rating · My Rating · Past Cycles . Quarterly Connects is no longer under Team
SMK-07	any	Open an old bookmark or notification link to <code>/team/connects</code>	Still opens Quarterly Connects. Only the menu position moved, not the URL

Expected, not a defect: an employee's nav still lists **Cycles, KRA Overview, Calibration, 9-Box Grid, Closure Letters and Super 50**. Those items carry no role gate on the menu, and the API refuses them with a 403 when opened. Access is correctly denied; only the menu is untidy. Raise it as cosmetic if you want it changed — do not log it as a security defect.

2. HR setup (phase: draft)

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
SET-01	hr	Cycles → create a cycle (name, fiscal year, type annual)	Created in phase draft
SET-02	hr	Employees → Download template → upload a small CSV → Validate	Dry run report. Nothing saved yet
SET-03	hr	Read the dry-run report	Shows rows, errors, warnings, reporting lines matched, and how many new hires would get KRAs
SET-04	hr	Upload a file with a bad row (missing email)	That row is reported by line number; the rest still validate
SET-05	hr	Commit load	Employees created/updated; report says what changed
SET-06	hr	Department Heads → add a department, assign a head	Department appears; the head gains hod
SET-07	hr	KRA Library → upload the library workbook (with Department) → Validate → Commit	Shelves published per designation
SET-08	hr	KRA Library → edit one KRA's title and weight inline	Saves. Employees who already picked that KRA are unaffected (see LIB-03)
SET-09	hr	Settings → confirm KRA library scope	department+designation is already set on this instance
SET-10	hr	Cycles → advance draft → kra_open	Advances. Employees can now see My KRAs
SET-11	hr	Try to advance kra_open → manager_eval (skipping two)	Refused — one step at a time

2.1 Auto-assign to new hires

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
NEW-01	hr	Import a file containing one brand-new employee with a designation that has a shelf → Validate	Report says that person will get N KRAs , names the matched scope and the weight total
NEW-02	hr	Commit the same file	The new hire's sheet is created with the shelf's KRAs, in draft
NEW-03	employee (new hire)	Sign in → My KRAs	The KRAs are there, editable, not yet submitted . Manager approval still required
NEW-04	hr	Re-import the exact same file	Nothing is assigned. new_hires: 0 . This is the most important case — a nightly HRMS sync must not overwrite anybody
NEW-05	hr	Import a new hire whose designation has no shelf (e.g. Vice President I)	Reported under "no library shelf for their designation", not silently skipped
NEW-06	hr	Import a new hire on the 105% shelf	Assigned, and flagged : weights do not total 100. The employee's notification says so
NEW-07	hr	Import an update to an existing employee with KRAs already on their sheet	Their KRAs are untouched

3. KRA setting (phase: `kra_open`)

3.1 The employee's own sheet

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
KRA-01	employee	My KRAs → add a KRA manually (title, measures, weight) → Save	Saved
KRA-02	employee	Set weights totalling 90 → Submit	Refused — "weights must total 100"
KRA-03	employee	Fix to exactly 100 → Submit	Submitted. Sheet locks. Manager notified
KRA-04	employee	Try to edit after submitting	Read-only
KRA-05	employee	Submit twice (browser back, re-click)	Refused — already submitted
KRA-06	employee	Submit with no manager set	Submits, with a warning that nobody was notified. Not a silent failure
KRA-07	hr, then employee	Advance the cycle to <code>mid_year_review</code> (or any later phase). Then, as an employee whose sheet is <code>draft</code> or <code>returned</code> , open My KRAs	Still editable and submittable. The cycle phase does not lock KRAs — only the sheet's own status does. This is the behaviour changed on request; verify it in at least two later phases
KRA-08	hr	Roll the cycle back one phase	Allowed, one step. Nobody's sheet is reopened as a side effect — the rollback used to unlock everybody

3.2 Choose from library

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
LIB-01	employee	My KRAs → Choose from library	Shelf for your designation opens
LIB-02	employee	Use Select all KRAs	All addable KRAs tick at once
LIB-03	employee	Add some, save. Then have HR edit that library entry (<code>SET-08</code>)	Your copy does not change. The library is a menu; what you picked is yours
LIB-04	employee	Pick enough KRAs to exceed 100%	Total shows amber ; submit refused until corrected
LIB-05	employee	Open the library when every KRA is already added	Button reads View library rather than being dead
LIB-06	employee	Check the department chooser	Shows your department and the others. <i>Currently every shelf resolves by designation only — see blocker #2</i>
LIB-07	employee (no shelf)	Open the library as e.g. Vice President I	Honest empty state naming the designation. Not a crash, not a fake shelf

3.3 HR acting on someone's behalf

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
HRB-01	hr	KRA Overview → search an employee → enter KRAs for them	Saved to that employee's sheet
HRB-02	hr	Submit on their behalf	Submitted; their manager is notified
HRB-03	hr	KRA Overview	Every employee listed with status, searchable

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
HRB-04	hr	Bulk KRA upload for many employees	Per-row result; failures named by row, not one flat error

3.4 Manager approval

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
MGR-01	manager	Team KRA Sheets	Your reports listed — including those who have not started , showing <code>not_started</code>
MGR-02	manager	Open a submitted sheet	The actual KRA lines, not just a count
MGR-03	manager	Return with no comment	Refused — a return needs a reason
MGR-04	manager	Return with a comment	Employee's sheet reopens; banner reads "Returned by your manager" with the comment
MGR-05	employee	Edit and resubmit	Works; the return label clears
MGR-06	manager	Approve	Status <code>approved</code> ; locked to the employee
MGR-07	manager	Try to open a sheet belonging to someone else's report (edit the URL)	403 — Not your report

3.5 Reopen on a job change — the four reasons a sheet comes back

This is the area with the most subtle behaviour. **The label must always be correct** — telling an employee their manager returned something when HR changed their department is a real-world complaint.

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
RE-01	hr	With the employee's sheet submitted , change their department	Sheet reopens. Banner: "Reopened after a change to your role" with <code>Department: X → Y</code> . Employee and manager notified
RE-02	employee	Look at My Growth and Mid-Year too	Both also reopened , same reason
RE-03	hr	Change their designation	Same as <code>RE-01</code> ; library beneath now shows the new designation's shelf
RE-04	hr	Change their role (employee → manager)	Same
RE-05	hr	Correct a name only	Nothing reopens . Only department, designation and role band count
RE-06	hr	Change their reporting manager	Nothing reopens — the objectives are the same, only the reviewer moved. The sheet moves to the new manager's queue
RE-07	hr	Re-import the same HRMS file unchanged	Nothing reopens . Getting this wrong reopens every sheet in the company nightly
RE-08	hr	KRA Overview → reopen an approved sheet	Banner reads "Reopened by HR" — <i>not</i> "returned by your manager"
RE-09	employee	After <code>RE-01</code> , resubmit. Then have the manager return it	Banner now reads "Returned by your manager" . The old label must not survive

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
RE-10	employee	After a role change, check Choose from library	Enabled, showing the new shelf. Old KRAs can be cleared with one button
RE-11	employee	Change KRAs, resubmit, then open My Growth	If any goal now serves a KRA no longer on your sheet, the plan reopens by itself , labelled " Reopened because your KRAs changed ", and the affected goals are marked

4. My Growth — development goals and career (phase: kra_open onward)

Growth opens **per employee, on their own KRA submission** — not on a phase.

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
GRW-01	employee	Open My Growth before submitting KRAs	Shut, with the reason: submit your KRAs first, <i>"this opens the moment you do"</i>
GRW-02	employee	Submit KRAs → reopen My Growth	Now editable
GRW-03	employee	Add a goal with no target date → Save	Refused , naming which goals lack a date
GRW-04	employee	Add goals, set Serves KRA from the dropdown	Saved and grouped by KRA
GRW-05	employee	Suggest goals (AI) → Select all → add	Suggestions arrive grouped by KRA, as editable goals
GRW-06	employee	Submit the plan	Locked; manager notified
GRW-07	manager	Team Development Plans → return it with a comment	Reopens for the employee
GRW-08	hr	Reopen a submitted plan from HR	Reopens, labelled "Reopened by HR"
GRW-09	employee	Aspiring Career → Suggest a path	Reads your designation/department against the Career Pathing Matrix. <i>Currently the matrix is empty — expect an honest "no career path configured" message, not a crash</i>
GRW-10	employee	Set target role, timeline, plan → Save	Saved

5. Quarterly Connects — through the year

Moved on request (22 Sep): this tab now sits in the **My Performance** group, between **My Growth** and **Mid-Year Review** — in the menu and in this guide. It follows the year as people live it: set your KRAs, plan your growth, hold your quarterly conversations, then review at the halfway point.

The page is two-sided: a manager logs and signs off connects with their reports, and an employee sees their own. The URL is unchanged (`/team/connects`), so existing bookmarks and notification links still work.

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
CON-01	manager	Quarterly Connects → log a connect with a report	Saved with date and notes
CON-02	manager	Add a meeting link and date	Accepted here (this is the tab that owns scheduling)
CON-03	manager	AI assist on connect notes	Draft summary, editable
CON-04	manager	Sign off a connect	Recorded
CON-05	hr	Review Analysis (HR)	7-parameter meeting analysis. HR/admin only
CON-06	employee	Try <code>/admin/parameter-analysis</code> by URL	Blocked
CON-07	—	Email invitations for connects	Not available — no mail transport is configured. Links must be shared manually

6. Mid-Year Review (phase: `mid_year_review`)

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
<code>MID-01</code>	hr	Advance the cycle to <code>mid_year_review</code>	Employees see the tab open
<code>MID-02</code>	employee	Mid-Year → rate each KRA, write a narrative	Overall computes from the per-KRA ratings
<code>MID-03</code>	employee	AI assist on the narrative	Draft appears, labelled as a draft, editable before saving
<code>MID-04</code>	employee	Save & sign	Locked to you
<code>MID-05</code>	manager	Team → the report's mid-year → rate and sign	Requires a narrative before signing
<code>MID-06</code>	employee	Look at the From the manager panel	"Not shared yet" — the manager's rating is withheld until HR publishes. You still see <i>whether</i> they have completed theirs
<code>MID-07</code>	employee	Check My KRAs	The mid-year strip per KRA shows your rating only
<code>MID-08</code>	hr	Change the employee's department now	Mid-Year reopens too, back to <code>in_progress</code> , with the reason
<code>MID-09</code>	any	Look for meeting links / dates on Mid-Year	Not here. Meeting scheduling lives in Quarterly Connects

7. Annual Review — the employee's self-appraisal (phase: self_appraisal)

Naming: the tab called **Annual Review** is the employee's own self-appraisal. The tab called **Final Rating** shows consolidated ratings. These were renamed on request; the URLs are unchanged.

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
ANN-01	hr	Advance to self_appraisal	Tab opens
ANN-02	employee	Write your self-appraisal per KRA	Saved
ANN-03	employee	AI assist	Draft bullets grouped by KRA, editable
ANN-04	employee	Submit	Locked
ANN-05	employee	Look for the manager's rating anywhere on the page	Withheld — "not shown yet ... after publish"

8. Manager evaluation → Delivery Head → Calibration

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
EVL-01	hr	Advance to manager_eval	Team Evaluation opens
EVL-02	manager	Score the 7 organisational parameters for a report	Overall rating is computed , not typed. On an annual cycle a directly-set rating is refused — this is correct
EVL-03	manager	Submit the evaluation	Locked
EVL-04	manager	Try to submit without scoring	Refused
EVL-05	employee	Check Final Rating / My Rating	Nothing from the manager is visible
HOD-01	hr	Advance to hod_eval	Delivery Head Review opens
HOD-02	hod	Open the queue	Only your departments' employees
HOD-03	hod	Change a manager's rating and submit	Recorded as the HOD rating; the manager's original is kept
HOD-04	employee	Check your rating	Still nothing visible
CAL-01	hr	Advance to calibration	Calibration opens
CAL-02	hr	Adjust a rating with a reason	Adjustment recorded with who and why
CAL-03	hr	9-Box Grid	Employees placed by performance × potential
CAL-04	hr	Super 50 watchlist	Flagged employees listed
CAL-05	hr	Increment Simulation	Recommended increments by rating band
CAL-06	manager	Try to open Increment Simulation	Not in nav, and blocked by URL. Pay is HR/admin only

9. Publish (phase: `publish`) — the rating visibility rule

This is the single most important behaviour to verify. Before publish an employee sees **only their own self-rating**. After publish they see everything. The data is withheld **at the source**, not hidden with CSS — check the network response, not just the screen.

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
<code>PUB-01</code>	hr	Advance to <code>publish</code>	Publish action available
<code>PUB-02</code>	manager	Try to publish	403. Publishing is HR and Super Admin only
<code>PUB-03</code>	employee	Before publishing: My KRAs, Mid-Year, Annual Review, Final Rating, My Rating	Only your own ratings. Manager / HOD / calibration ratings absent everywhere, each with an explanation rather than a blank dash
<code>PUB-04</code>	hr	Publish	Ratings written to history; letters created; employees notified
<code>PUB-05</code>	employee	Re-open the same five tabs	Everything now visible — manager, Delivery Head and final rating
<code>PUB-06</code>	employee	Final Rating tab	Consolidated view of all levels
<code>PUB-07</code>	hr	Closure Letters	Letter per employee, downloadable
<code>PUB-08</code>	hr	Advance to <code>closed</code>	Cycle closed; Past Cycles shows it
<code>PUB-09</code>	employee	Past Cycles	Your published history

10. HR reporting

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
RPT-01	hr	PMS Completion Report	Who has completed which stage
RPT-02	hr	KRA Overview counters	Counts match the rows listed
RPT-03	hr	Cycles → cycle activity	Audit of what happened in the cycle
RPT-04	hr	Export any report offered	Downloads and opens

11. Employee self-service

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
EMP-01	employee	My Rating	Your own rating only, respecting the publish rule
EMP-02	employee	Past Cycles	Previous published cycles
EMP-03	employee	People Hub / Engagement	Loads; surveys can be taken
EMP-04	employee	Upload evidence against a KRA	Attached; visible to you and your manager

12. Super Admin

ID	Role	Steps	Expected
ADM-01	admin	Sign in	All 29 nav items visible
ADM-02	admin	Team KRA Sheets, Team Evaluation, Team Overview, Team Development Plans	Every employee listed, not just your reports. A all employees · super admin chip appears on the page
ADM-03	admin	Find yourself in those lists	You are there
ADM-04	admin	Submit your own KRAs, then approve your own sheet	Allowed
ADM-05	admin	Approve at manager level for someone who is not your report	Allowed
ADM-06	admin	Delivery Head Review	All departments, not just yours
ADM-07	manager	Open the same four team tabs	Only your own reports. No chip. This is the leak test — it matters more than ADM-02
ADM-08	employee	Open the same four tabs	403
ADM-09	hr	Ask your DBA to run the query below after ADM-04	Your self-approval is listed

```
-- every action where the actor approved their own record
SELECT at, actor_email, action, employee_id
  FROM pms.audit_log
 WHERE details->>'self_action' = 'true'
 ORDER BY at DESC;
```

13. Negative and security tests

Run these as a **plain employee** unless stated. All should be refused.

ID	Attempt	Expected
SEC-01	Open <code>/admin/directory</code> , <code>/admin/kra-library</code> , <code>/admin/increments</code> by URL	Blocked
SEC-02	Open another employee's KRA sheet by editing the id in the URL	403
SEC-03	Approve your own KRA sheet as a plain employee	403
SEC-04	As a manager, open a sheet belonging to another manager's report	403 — Not your report
SEC-05	As a manager, reach Increment Simulation or Review Analysis	Blocked — pay and the confidential analysis are HR/admin only
SEC-06	Submit a KRA sheet with weights $\neq$ 100	422 with the actual total named
SEC-07	Submit a growth plan with a goal missing a target date	422 naming the goals
SEC-08	Put a malformed id in any URL (<code>/team/kra-sheets/not-a-uuid/kras</code>)	Clean 400 — never a 500 with a database message
SEC-09	Read a rating before publish via the API directly	Absent from the response body, not merely hidden on screen
SEC-10	Sign in as a deactivated employee	Refused

14. Automated test suite

586 automated tests across 79 files, run against a real Postgres and the real HTTP surface. Run these before signing off any release — they cover far more edge cases than manual testing reasonably can.

```
cd server
createdb apms_check          # MUST be a fresh database every run
DATABASE_URL=postgres://postgres:pgpass@127.0.0.1:5432/apms_check \
DATABASE_SSL=false JWT_SECRET=t TENANT_SLUG=x AUTH_DEV=true npm test
```

Expected: `# pass 586`, `# fail 0`.

⚠ A fresh database each run is not optional. Re-running against a used database produces four phantom failures in `self-appraisal-rating.test.js` that are artefacts of leftover state, not real defects.

The files worth knowing by name when a manual test fails — read the header comment, it states what the rule is and why:

Area	File
Phase rules, KRA lock	<code>phase-machine.test.js</code> , <code>kra-sheet-lock.test.js</code>
Reopen on a job change	<code>kra-reopen-on-profile-change.test.js</code> , <code>growth-reopen-on-profile-change.test.js</code> , <code>midyear-reopen-on-profile-change.test.js</code>
Reopen when KRAs change	<code>growth-reopen-on-kra-change.test.js</code>
Rating visibility before publish	<code>manager-rating-visibility.test.js</code>
Super admin + self-approval	<code>super-admin-access.test.js</code>
New-hire auto-assign	<code>kra-autoassign-on-joining.test.js</code>
Draft-cycle lockout	<code>active-cycle-draft-lockout.test.js</code>
Library	<code>kra-library.test.js</code> , <code>kra-library-edit.test.js</code>
Permissions	<code>uuid-params.test.js</code> , <code>employees.test.js</code>

15. Deploy verification

After any deploy, confirm on the server:

```
git -C /opt/agentica-pms log -1 --format='%h %s'
systemctl is-active agentica-pms-api nginx
curl -fsS http://127.0.0.1/api/v1/health          # {"ok":true}
sudo journalctl -u agentica-pms-api --since '-5 min' -p err

DB=$(sudo grep -oP '^DATABASE_URL=.*[/\K[A-Za-z0-9_]+' /etc/agentica-pms/api.env | head -1)
sudo -u postgres psql -d "$DB" -tAc "SELECT count(*) FROM core.migrations_log"
```

Migrations run in-process at boot and **fail the boot** if one throws, so a bad migration stops a deploy rather than half-applying it.

16. Known limitations — do not raise these as defects

Area	Status
Google Meet integration	Framework present, no credentials. Manual links only
Email / calendar invitations	No mail transport configured. Nothing is emailed by the product
Career Pathing Matrix	Screen and upload work; no data loaded , so suggestions have nothing to read
Department-based KRA shelves	Working, but inert until the library is re-uploaded with a Department column
KRA unique ID by department + designation	Not built — awaiting four design decisions
Auto-assign for existing employees	By design, new hires only. Existing staff pick from the library

17. Reporting a defect

Please include all six. Most of the round-trips on this project have been spent establishing items 4 and 5.

1. **Test ID** from this guide (`RE-09`), or a description if it is not covered
2. **Role and account** you were signed in as
3. **The cycle's current phase** — visible on the Cycles tab
4. **The record's own status** — sheet `submitted` / `approved` , plan `returned` , etc.
5. **What you expected vs what happened**, in those words
6. **A screenshot** showing the whole page, including the nav and any banner

If a rating is missing, state **whether the cycle has been published** before raising it — withheld-before-publish is the designed behaviour (§9), and it is the single most common false report.

18. Sign-off

Section	Cases	Tester	Date	Pass / Fail
1 Smoke	7			
2 HR setup + auto-assign	18			
3 KRA setting	37			
4 My Growth	10			
5 Quarterly Connects	7			
6 Mid-Year	9			
7 Annual Review	5			
8 Evaluation → Calibration	15			
9 Publish + visibility	9			
10 HR reporting	4			
11 Employee self-service	4			
12 Super Admin	9			
13 Negative / security	10			
14 Automated suite	586			

Total: 144 manual cases + 586 automated.